1.5 The changing world of work

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how computer communication has changed the way people work.



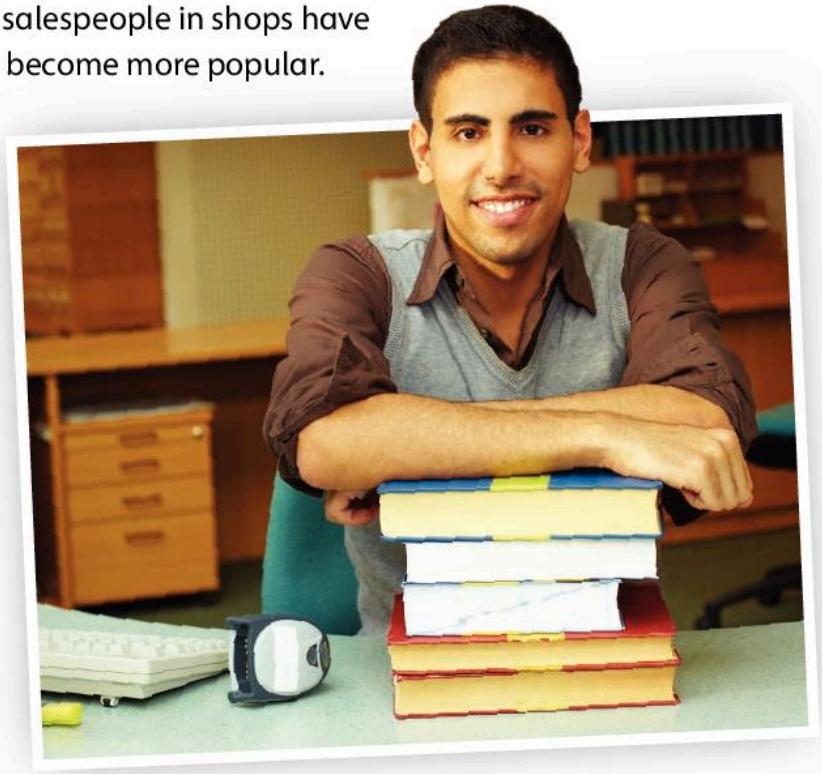
New jobs

The internet has changed the way people work. New jobs have appeared that did not exist before. There are technical jobs like network manager. There are creative jobs like web designer and games programmer.

Old jobs – new skills

The internet has changed existing jobs. A librarian used to work with books that were stored on shelves. Today, the librarian also needs the skills to find information on the web.

Some people have lost their jobs. Automation and robots have replaced low-skilled jobs in factories. Some salespeople in shops have lost their jobs because online shopping has become more popular.



As jobs change, people need to learn new skills. Some people find change exciting. Other people feel threatened by change.

The internet can make it easier to find a new job. There are websites that advertise job vacancies. People can apply for jobs by entering information about their skills on a database. Details of new job vacancies are emailed to them.

Different ways of working

Working in teams

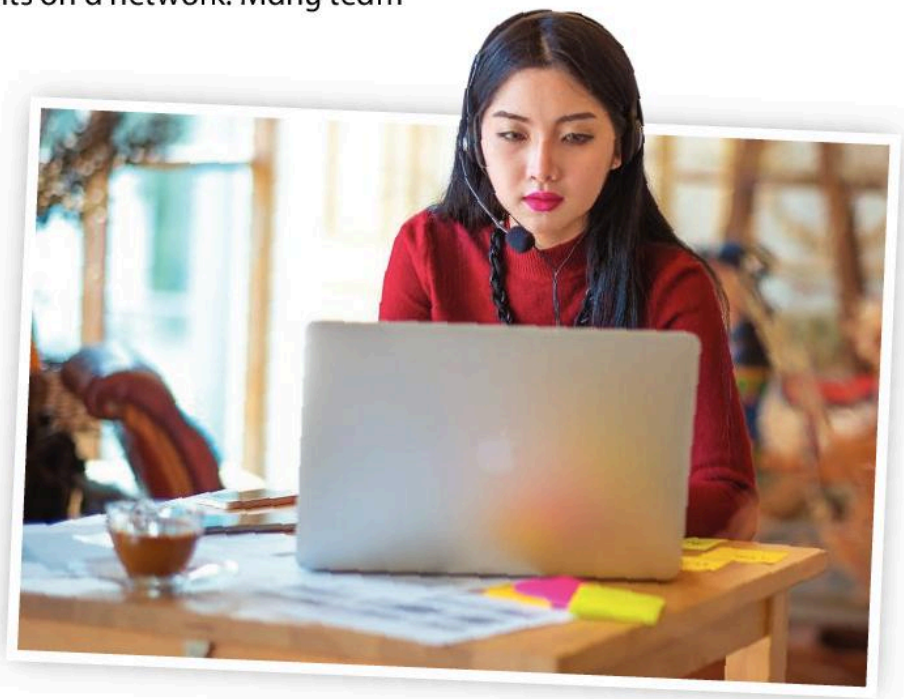
In the past, work teams mostly worked in the same building. The members of a team met regularly face to face to work on projects.

The internet allows people to communicate and share information with colleagues wherever they are in the world. Today, many teams are made up of people working in different cities and even countries. The team members share documents on a network. Many team members never meet face to face.

Teleworking

In the past, people travelled to an office or factory every day to do their work. The internet allows people to communicate using email, internet chat and video conferencing. People can access the information they need to do their work using networks and the internet.

This means that people can work from home. This is called **teleworking**. People don't have to travel so much and can fit work around their home life.





Activity

Describe your dream job when you grow up. How will you use a computer in your job?



Extra challenge

Make an advert for your dream job. Include the computer skills that are needed for the job.



Explore more

Find out what the adults in your family and other grown-up friends think about teleworking. Ask these questions.

1. Do you ever do part of your job from home using an internet link?
2. Could you do more of your job from home using an internet link?
3. Would you like to do more work from home?

Ask any other questions you can think of. Write down the people's answers so you can share them with the class.

1.6 Living with the internet

In this lesson

You will learn:

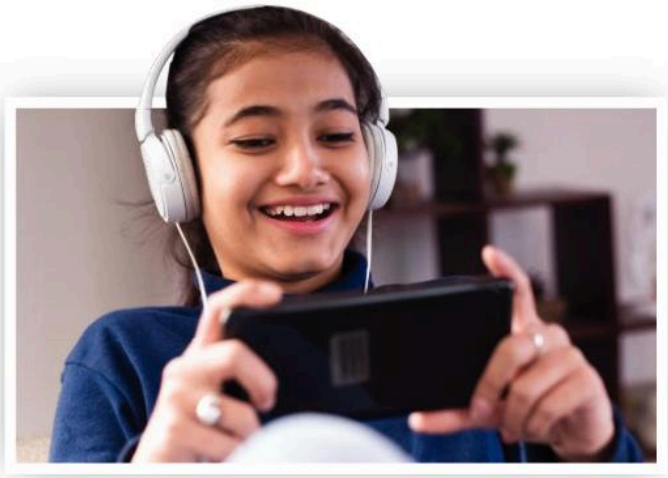
- how the internet affects our lives.

How the internet affects you

The internet has changed the way we lead our lives. Many of the changes have been positive.

Communication: The internet allows you to communicate using text, voice and video. You can share pictures and files. You can use the internet to find advice or to solve a problem.

Information: You use information every day to help you learn, work and lead your daily life. The internet has made information easier and quicker to find.



Convenience: The internet provides 'on-demand' services. This means you can use services when you want them. People use internet banking to pay for things they buy online. You can choose from thousands of shops on the internet. You can download music, games and videos instantly.

Remote control: In Lesson 1.4 you learned about smart devices in the home that allow you to control air conditioning, heating, lighting and security systems remotely.



The dark side of the web



If you use the internet responsibly, you will enjoy its benefits. But be aware that there is a negative side to the internet.

Not everything you read is true

The information on the web is often called content. Some of the content may be false. The writer may make a mistake or they may deliberately write false or misleading content. Some writers may write false content to persuade you to accept their opinions or to sell you something.

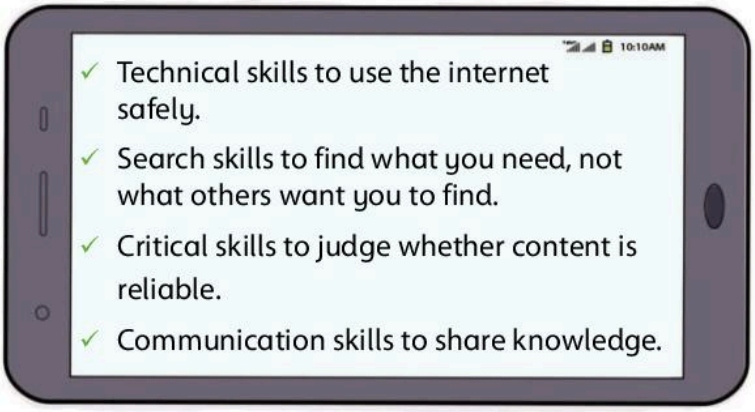
Don't trust everyone you meet online

Criminals use the internet. Some criminals use fake emails or websites to try to steal money or personal information. Other criminals trade illegal and counterfeit (fake) goods.

Some people use social media or text messages to send threats or to spread cruel rumours. If someone tries to bully or frighten you online, do not reply to the bully. Report the problem to a responsible adult.

Staying safe on the internet

To stay safe on the internet you need to develop these skills.



You will develop some of these skills in Unit 2.



Activity

Imagine that your friend has received threatening text messages from an anonymous person. Write a set of bullet points advising your friend how to deal with the problem.



Extra challenge

Create a poster with the title 'Good internet / Bad internet'. Use one half of the poster to promote the positive side of the internet. Use the other half to warn about the negative side of the internet.



Explore more

Find out how old your parents or grandparents were when the web was invented. Do they remember the first time they used the web?